

Succession Planning Basics

Build a family document file

Inheritance and succession depend on religion, domicile, assets, documents, and applicable personal and succession laws. This checklist helps a family prepare facts.

- Keep the death certificate, CNICs, family-registration certificate, and relationship records.
- List land, bank accounts, vehicles, shares, businesses, insurance, and debts.
- Store original title deeds and nominate a trusted document custodian.

Identify the legal route

Do not assume every asset is identical

The applicable forum and certificate can differ between bank balances, movable property, land, and company interests.

- Ask the relevant bank, land authority, or registrar which current certificate they require.
- Check whether a will, nomination, gift, court order, or prior transfer exists.
- Record each heir's relationship and contact details accurately.

Family agreement and evidence

Reduce avoidable conflict

Do not pressure a person to sign away rights or distribute property without checking title and applicable law.

- Make a neutral asset-and-liability schedule.
- Keep written consent, receipts, valuations, and meeting notes.
- Use mediation or qualified advice where family members disagree.

Land and financial records

Verify before transferring

Confirm ownership and encumbrances with the relevant authority. A bank nomination may not by itself resolve every succession question.

- Obtain certified copies and track application numbers.
- Never hand over original documents without a signed receipt.
- Be alert to fraud, forged powers of attorney, and urgent pressure to sell.

Official sources and reminder

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- National Database and Registration Authority (NADRA): <https://www.nadra.gov.pk/>
- Punjab Land Records Authority: <https://www.punjab-zameen.gov.pk/>

This is educational information only. Succession is fact-specific; obtain qualified advice before distributing or transferring assets.